

## 100 years ago

I met upon a journey, a man of five score years,  
Just like a leaf in autumn, that the hard frost browns  
and sears  
His eye was dim his cheek was wan, his form was worn  
and bent  
The light of life still flickered, but the oil was nearly  
spent.  
He talked about weather, the state of crops and roads,  
Of implements for farming, of different styles and  
modes  
"You think," said he "that times are hard and cash  
comes in too slow  
I wish you had lived in Shipman's Falls one hundred  
years ago."

"You have a daily mail, a railroad, you have shops  
beside your door  
To Morphy's Falls or on to Bytown we went to find a  
store.  
As there was no competition, the wily merchant seized  
The golden opportunity to charge what price he pleased.  
I've sometimes paid five shillings for a pound of  
common tea  
And the price of brown sugar was often one and three.  
It has cost me one and sixpence for a yard of calico  
And the same for factory cotton, one hundred years  
ago."

"The little crooked footpaths were our only roads at  
first  
And with fallen trees and mud holes they were freely  
interspersed.  
On journeys after dark, we took, to keep wild beasts at  
bay,  
A torch or two of good pitch pine which also lit the way.  
And through the gloomy forest you could hear the  
gaunt wolf howl  
The yarlking of the catamount, the hooting of an owl.  
When neighbours were in trouble, of course we had to  
go  
But we did not walk of pleasure, one hundred years  
ago."

"We went on foot or horse back but by and bye we  
found a way  
Broad enough by careful teaming for the oxen and the  
sleigh.  
But of surveying instruments, we did not need a load.  
For a woman rang a cowbell while her husband blazed  
the road.  
Two discs cut from a big round log, made the first affair  
on wheels.  
And when that cart was coming, you could hear, for  
miles, its squeals.  
We all ran outside to see it, 'twas a wonder then you  
know,  
That pioneer conveyance of one hundred years ago."

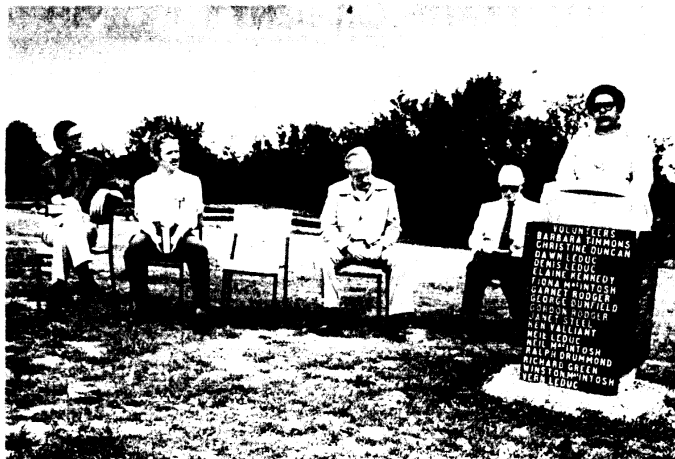
"And when we had a grist to grind or trading we must  
do it  
It meant a trip and a rough one it was too.  
After two or three days absence, when returning with  
our sacks,  
We trudged our lonely homeward way, with the flour  
upon our backs.  
The children all were waiting, for bread was such a treat  
They could scarcely wait with patience till the cakes  
were fit to eat.  
The children of the present would scorn such fare, I  
know,  
They haven't got the appetites of one hundred years  
ago."

Your stylish stoves and ranges were things unheard of  
when  
We settled in this country, we used clay ovens then.  
We would build about a rounded frame bricks made of  
straw and clay,  
And made within a roaring fire, and kept it on all day.  
And when the warmth had dried the sides our oven was  
complete,  
A crackling fire within it threw out cartloads of heat  
And then we raked the wood and coals out on the  
ground below  
And in it baked the bread and beans of one hundred  
years ago.

"Ah yes, there's been a mighty change, the forests now  
are cleared  
You seldom see a stumpy field, they've slowly disap-  
peared  
To bind, mow, rake and harrow about your fields you  
ride.  
The sickle, flail and hand fan are long since laid aside  
But many a poor fellow grubbed his crop in with a hoe  
To feed his little family, on hundred years ago."

"On the long, long winter evenings when the full moon  
shed her light  
We took the homelike - traneau out and yoked up  
Buck and Bright  
And a load of happy youngsters went to see the neigh-  
bour folks  
And we made the old woods echo with our laughter and  
our jokes  
Pianos, harps and organs, our homes had never been  
But our hearts were light and happy with the sweet  
toned violin  
And in the low, scooped shanty by the hearth fires ruddy  
glow  
We danced away the sorrows of one hundred years  
ago."

Author Unknown



A hot sunny day set the scene for the Re-dedication Service of the restored Pioneer Methodist Cemetery on highway 29. Here, Jean Steel, President of North Lanark Historical Society makes the transfer of responsibility for the cemetery to Ronald Robertson, Reeve of Ramsey Township. On her right are George Dunfield, Chairman; Reverend Harry Brown, Reverend Kenneth McBurney and Reverend Wesley Mitchell.

## News from Pakenham library

by Toby Barratt

With all the rainy weather we have had what else is there to do but get a good book from the library and read. This week's newest selections are as follows:

**Tender Mercies** by Roselle Brown - Laura and Dan have been married for twelve years. They're happy together. They have two young children. Then, one day, in an act of casual bravado (the boyish swagger that Laura has so loved in him), Dan takes the tiller of a boat he can't handle. Laura is injured, completely paralysed. The story is of what happens when a solid, a true but not perfect, an invulnerable, marriage is tested to the utmost.

**The Spring of the Tiger** by Victoria Holt - Sarah from cool London town went into the heat of the tropical sun, among the tea plantations and the pearl divers of that high island of Ceylon. Death stared her in the face from the direction from which she least expected it.

**The Lamb's War** by Jan de Hartog - At the heart of this immensely rich novel is the relationship of a Dutch girl, Laura Martens, and an American boy, Boniface Baker, who meet in a just liberated Nazi concentration camp. They are both Quakers. Laura has survived three years of the camp and Boniface, an idealistic ambulance driver, is determined to save Laura. He takes her to the U.S. where they are soon launched upon a passionate and heartrending adventure.

**The Bloodied Toga** by W. G. Hardy - This is the sequel to the book 'The Scarlet Mantle' and continues the story of Caesar right to the Ides of March and the confusion that follows.

**Confessions** by Barbara Amiel - This is an astonishing frank autobiography, the story of a political odyssey from left to right to center, an all out attack on the Canadian media and other institutions that break the unwritten rules, by naming no names, and a

warning about what big Government has in store for all of us.

**Ann Erma's Cope Book** by Erma Bombeck - How to get from Monday to Friday in 12 days and give you a bit of a smile as well.

**Colombo's Canadian References** - a book of over 6,000 entries on people, places, and things of Canadian interest. This mini-encyclopedia is a handy compendium of information for general readers and even non-readers.

**The Canadian Wood Heat Book** by Gordon Flager - This book contains everything you need to know to choose a wood heating appliance wisely and install it safely. It tells you where to find your wood supply and how to harvest, season and store wood properly. The volume at the end of the book lists all the major wood heating units now on the market.

**The Trouble with Princesses** by Christie Harris - a

book all about princesses, both new world and some from the old. For public school readers.

**The Pillow by Rosemary Allison** - a story of a new Canadian and how she adjusts to her new life. For young listeners and beginning readers.

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